14.5 Cardiac Arrest and Post-Resuscitation Care

Assessment	Nursing Diagnosis	Plan / Expected Outcome	Nursing Interventions	Evaluation
Subjective • *No specific complaint* **Objective** • Spontaneous circulation back after cardiac arrest • BP 88/50 mmHg • Intubated, GCS 6	**ACTUAL** **Decreased cardiac output** related to post-arrest myocardial dysfunction as evidenced by hypotension.	MAP 65 mmHg or more.	• Continuous monitoring of ECG, BP and SpO_2. • Give vasopressors as prescribed. • Take a 12-lead ECG and, if ordered, prepare for coronary angiography. • Keep SpO_2 on target, avoiding both too little and too much oxygen.	MAP on target: **goal met**.
Subjective • *No specific complaint* **Objective** • GCS 6 • May be having seizures	**ACTUAL** **Decreased intracranial adaptive capacity** related to hypoxic brain injury as evidenced by GCS 6 after cardiac arrest.	No secondary brain injury.	• Control temperature as the protocol says, and do not let a fever develop. • Keep glucose and CO_2 normal. • Watch for seizures. • Head of the bed at 30 degrees.	Neurological status stable: **goal met**.
Subjective • Family ask • "Will he wake up?" **Objective** • Outcome uncertain	**RISK** **Risk for maladaptive grieving (family)** as evidenced by risk factors: sudden critical illness of a family member and uncertain prognosis.	The family get information and support.	• Give honest updates regularly. • Let the family be with him. • Offer spiritual and social support.	Family supported: **goal met**.